Brahman (The Supreme Being): the idea that underlying the flux of empirical experience there is a static, all-pervasive, animating yet immutable reality that is immanent in the cosmos in that it is identical with the essence of everything including human beings.

Atman (soul): a changeless identity beyond space, time and finite human forms of experience. It is either identical with ***Brahman*** or intimately related to it. This centre of consciousness may become tied to a body, mind, will and senses. Burdened by the consequences of actions, this is what is reborn.

Release (***moksha***) from the series of births is possible through intuitive knowledge arising from the study of these texts.

Further reading: Hume 1949; Olivelle 1996; Radhakrishnan 1953; Rocher 1988

Utpaladeva (925–75 CE): following ***Somananda***, a major theorist of the ***Pratyabhijna*** school of non-dualistic *Kashmiri Shaivism*. His principal protagonists are Buddhists belonging to the ***Dignaga–Dharmakirti*** tradition, whose representationalist theory of perceptual process he acutely translated into absolute idealism. ***Dharmakirti*** thinks that the mind forms images (*akara*) based on the sensory impressions that we have of objective reality consisting of a flux of unique momentary particulars (***svalakshana***). These mental images are then interpreted in concepts. *Utpaladeva* rejected the notion of a mind-independent realm of particulars. What the mind processes are manifestations (*abhasa*) that are themselves projected by the universal supreme consciousness. He thinks that our experience of a structured reality and our continuous awareness of ourselves as the same person